

THE PARTY LEADER LESSON • LESSON 6 OF 6

Lead Your AI Squad



45 minutes, no prep. Students write one quest card, play the AI squad in silence, then check the loot like the leader whose name is on it.

AT A GLANCE

TIME	MATERIALS	TECH NEEDED	PREP
45 min	Run the Quest worksheet (3 pages; typeable PDF included) · Slides (optional) · scrap paper (1 per student) · board · Teacher Guide	None — unplugged. Optional: projector; your AI account (with-devices block, p.2)	Print; don't staple p.1. Plan teams of 3. That's it.

OBJECTIVES & STANDARDS

- Write a four-part **quest card** an agent can't misread. (*Step 2; Exit #1*)
- Do one **squad role** (planner, scout, or critic) in silence. (*Step 3; Exit #2*)
- Review work with the **CHECK rubric**; write a keep-and-fix note. (*Step 4; Exit #3*)

ISTE 1.5.c

ISTE 1.7.c

CCSS ELA W.6.4

☑ WARM-UP — IT DID EXACTLY WHAT YOU SAID (6 MIN)

"My new party member: maxed-out stats, never sleeps, never complains — painfully literal. Last night's run:"

"Guard the door." → Guarded the door. Only the door. The enemies used the window.

"Grab everything in the chest." → Everything. Including the cursed amulet with the obvious skull on it.

"Buy potions." → How many? It guessed ALL. Spent 900 gold, then sold your sword.

Then ask: **whose fault was that — the party member's, or the orders?**

Bridge: "A chatbot answers a question. An AI agent does a whole job, step by step, on its own — and if your card leaves something out, the agent usually fills the gap with a guess and keeps going. Like the potions. Some agents stop and ask instead. That's why the leader checks. You'll never out-work it. You CAN out-lead it."

What if nobody laughs? Take a fourth order from the room and ruin it too: *"Heal me"* → healed you. Once.

Transition: "Today you learn the leader's loop: quest card, roles, check the loot — ship it or run it back."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION — THE PARTY LEADER'S LOOP (9 MIN)

Board: **QUEST CARD** → **ROLES** → **CHECK THE LOOT** → **SHIP IT or RUN IT BACK.**

QUEST CARD — four parts, in writing: **goal** (what winning means), **what we know** (who it's for, what the team has), **rules of the run** (length, tone, deadline), **done looks like** (the exact thing handed back). (If your class did the genie lesson: this is P.R.O. grown up.)

ROLES — nobody solos the raid: a **planner**, a **scout**, a **critic** — same card, one slice each.

CHECK THE LOOT — **accuracy** (facts match the card; every ✓ has a "how we know"), **taste** (fits the audience and tone — or could it be for anyone at all?), **done-ness** (did they do their whole role card?). Every paper gets a keep-and-fix note, even SHIP IT work.

DIRECT INSTRUCTION (CONT.)

Watch one get fixed — build it on the board, part by part. Cursed order: *"Plan the game night."* → **quest card**: "GOAL: get 6th graders to actually show up to Game Night. WHAT WE KNOW: Friday, gym, 6–8 pm; we have board games and two TVs. RULES OF THE RUN: school-appropriate, big readable title, 40 words max. DONE LOOKS LIKE: one flyer draft, ready to photocopy." Then: **"Party leaders don't do the quest twice. When the loot is off, check the card first. If the card was clear, the fix goes to the party member."**

What if "too long"? Count it — four lines. *"Four lines now, or a flyer that says 'games all night' later."*

Hand-out: "Page 1. Teams of 3. ONE card per team; the first name in ABC order writes. Eight minutes."

ACTIVITY — RUN THE QUEST (24 MIN)

1. **Write the quest card (8 min):** Game Night flyer or class magazine, issue #1. ONE card per team.

What if a team stalls on GOAL? *"What would make you say we won?"*

Switch: "Cards done. Card-holder, you're the Planner: page 1 face-up in the middle. Of the other two, first name in ABC order is the Scout. Sit in a triangle. The Scout sits on the Planner's left; the Critic sits on the Scout's left. For 8 minutes YOU play an AI agent. Silence starts now."

2. **Squad works (8 min):** at the 4-minute call: "Critics, read your Planner's list over their shoulder — 3 upgrades. Planners, keep writing: time every step, star the riskiest. Scouts, turn each ? into a question."

Plant the cursed amulet (minute 2): whisper to each Scout, *"Secret job. Make up ONE fact that sounds true, and mark it ✓ like you checked it. Tell nobody."* Now the loot has a guess to catch.

What if the class doesn't divide by 3? *Team of 4: two critics, same pass-left rule. Team of 2: no critic.*

Swap: "Time. Every paper moves one seat to its owner's left — the Planner's plan goes to the Scout, the Scout's questions go to the Critic, the Critic's list goes to the Planner. Keep your worksheet; you lead again on page 2."

3. **Leader review (8 min):** the CHECK rubric (worksheet p.2): a quoted line and a ticked box per row, then the keep-and-fix note. Last 60 seconds: "Hand it back. FIX lines out loud: Scouts, then Critics, then Planners."

What if a leader turns harsh? *KEEP before FIX, and they read the note aloud to their party member.*

Into the exit ticket (the reveal): "Critics, who found a fact that isn't on the card? Scouts, tell them: I asked you to make one up. Agents usually guess at a gap. Leaders catch it. Page 3, solo."

EXIT TICKET (6 MIN)

Worksheet p.3, solo: #1 a quest card for a **real task in their own life**; #2 which role should start first, and why; #3 the check an AI's work would most likely fail, and what to look for. Collect; key: Teacher Guide, p.3.

What if a student writes a wish (*"help me with math"*)? *"Which part would stop a stranger guessing? Add it."*

DIFFERENTIATION

Support: sentence starters (Teacher Guide, p.1). **ELL:** draft in their strongest language first; gloss solo, raid, and loot on the board. **Extension:** a card so tight the critic can't land a note. **No devices:** built in.

With devices (optional — teacher's projected account only; students never log in):

1. **Paste** a team's card word for word. Add: "Do the planner's job, then the scout's."
2. **Review** it as a class with the CHECK rubric — SHIP IT or RUN IT BACK per check.
3. **Watch for** an invented fact (*"games all night"*), a skipped rule, an extra step.
4. **Fix the card, not the output:** add the missing rule, run it again, compare.
5. **Time:** 6–8 min. Best as a day-2 opener, before the class forgets its own cards.